ATKINSRÉALIS UK&I KEY ACCOUNT MANAGEMENT · THE GRAND, BIRMINGHAM · 17 NOVEMBER 2026

AtkinsRéalis

Bigger, Bolder, Believe

How to lead key accounts in a new world with clarity.

Your notes from the session with Caspar Craven. The three questions, the charts I had to redraw, and space to redraw your own.

- **What am I not seeing?**
- **How aligned is our team?**
- **Impossible, or just hard?**

You can't navigate a new world using an old set of charts

> **"The pace of change will never be this slow again."**
>
> McKinsey

> **"You don't sail round the world. You sail the next four hours. One watch at a time."**
>
> Ian, Southern Ocean, 2000

You can't deliver transformation with the same thinking that created today's results.

Vision 35 is a clear ambition: from 3 billion to 7.5 billion. The question is how. Under pressure you don't rise to the moment. You fall back on your old chart. The work is deciding which of it still holds, and what needs redrawing.

QUESTION 1

What does Vision 35 ask of me, in the accounts and the relationships I hold?

THREE TRANSFORMATIONS, THREE QUESTIONS

1 What am I not seeing?

2 How aligned is our team?

3 Impossible, or just hard?

What am I not seeing?

Leading the fleet, then crashing. I had it the wrong way round: numbers over people, win at all costs. People felt unseen, unheard, unappreciated.

THE OLD CHART

Results first.
Eyes only on the finish line.

THE NEW CHART

People first.
One watch at a time.

Put people first and the results will follow.

Google studied 180 teams. The best weren't the ones that avoided mistakes. They were the ones where people felt safe enough to admit them early. Accountability starts with people telling you the truth.

QUESTION 2 · THE ONE TO ASK ON MONDAY

"Would you mind telling me something I don't seem to realise?"

Who will you ask, and when? What do you expect to hear?

THINK OF THE CLIENT YOU'RE HOLDING

What am I not seeing about them? About what they will need next?

How aligned is our team?

Going fast and alone, until a friend said: carry on like this and you'll lose all of us. The values conversation I rolled my eyes at was the one that saved the company.

THE OLD CHART

Go fast. Go alone.
I'm right.

THE NEW CHART

Go far. Go together.
How do I know I'm right?

If you want to go fast, go alone. If you want to go far, go together.
African proverb

THE POWER OF VALUES



Values shape behaviours, behaviours become actions, actions create outcomes, and outcomes reinforce the values.

DESIGN FROM THE FUTURE · THE OLD CHART

Start from today.
Plan forwards.

THE NEW CHART

Start from the future.
Work back to now.

QUESTION 3

How aligned is your team? Not "are we", which everyone answers yes. How aligned.

VISION 35

Do you all have a clear picture of what Vision 35 looks like? What will you see? What will you hear? What will you feel?

Impossible, or just hard?

No money, no boat, a wife seasick both times she'd sailed, three crew who hadn't chosen it. Nine reasons it couldn't be done. Every one of them was an opinion until we tested it.

THE OLD CHART

That's impossible.
Shrink the goal.

THE NEW CHART

That's just hard.
Build the capability.

Impossible is usually an opinion, not a fact.

Two tests. Does it defy physics? Has someone, somewhere, done something similar? If no and yes, it's not impossible. It's just hard. Every "we can't" in a company is a capability nobody has been asked to build yet. Microsoft under Satya Nadella asked the same question of a company of a hundred thousand people: what's really impossible here, and what's just hard?

Why	Why not?

QUESTION 4

What bigger problem could you help this client solve?

QUESTION 5

What are you assuming about the client, the opportunity or your own capability?

YOUR TURN

Redraw your chart

Don't wait for perfect. A watch, in a business, is an experiment: small enough to start this week, reversible if it's wrong, and you learn something either way. Pick one thing, with one client, by when.

MY OLD CHART

MY NEW CHART

THE QUESTION I'LL KEEP ASKING

What am I not seeing? | How aligned is our team? | Impossible, or just hard?

My next experiment

With which client, by when

On Monday I'll tell my team

How I'll know it worked

Commit to it at bigboldgoals.com/atkins and I'll check in with you.